

Create Cool Android Apps with AppInventor 2

Most wannabe app inventors are daunted by the coding aspect of Android app development. Read on to discover how even a novice with no knowledge of coding can create an app and get it running in a short time by using AppInventor2.



Building Android apps is a real cool thing to do. So how would you react if I told you that you can make an Android app with zero knowledge about programming languages? This is exactly what AppInventor allows us to do—create cool Android apps with absolutely no coding. AppInventor is a project from 'the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) and is similar to the Scratch Project from the same renowned institution.

Set-up

AppInventor is a browser-based tool; so to create an app, you do not need to download any software. The system requirements are:

Browser

1. Mozilla Firefox 3.6 or higher
2. Apple Safari 5.0 or higher
3. Google Chrome 4.0 or higher

Phone or tablet (or the use of the on-screen emulator)

- Android 2.3 (Gingerbread) or higher

At the time of writing this article, there is no support for Internet Explorer. You will also need a Google account to create your apps.

To test your app, there are two options available:

1. If you are using an Android device and you have a wireless Internet connection, you can start building apps without downloading any software on your computer. You will also need to install the App Inventor Companion app for your device.
2. If you do not have an Android device, you'll need to install software on your computer so that you can use the on-screen Android emulator. This is available only for Windows and Mac at this point of time.

I will be dealing with the emulator in my article, which will be based on the methods I have tested on Firefox 27.0.1 on the Windows 7 platform.

As I have already mentioned, to create the app you